Blume Ventures | Program Manager - Network Programs

ABOUT US

Blume Ventures (www.blume.vc) is one of India's leading early-stage Venture Capital firms. We invest quite early on in a startup's journey and walk alongside them as they grow from "Unknowns to Unicorns". Our investment approach is a balance between data-driven, research-backed decisions based on industry trends, and drawing from our collective years of experience as investors, operators, ex-entrepreneurs and domain experts. We believe in the power of technology, and invest in companies that have the potential to solve big problems at scale in sectors such as deeptech, fintech, healthcare, edtech, mobility, consumer and lifestyle, among others. Some of our marquee investments include Unacademy, Spinny, Grey Orange Robotics, Purplle, ElectricPe, Dunzo, HealthifyMe, Classplus, Ultrahuman, Pixxel, and CarbonClean.

We have recently closed our flagship fund IV, our biggest ever, to back the next wave of revolutionary founders and ventures. We are seeing bigger dreams, and bigger ambitions in these new founders, in larger numbers than ever before. They are targeting bigger problems and bigger opportunities, inspired and motivated by the first wave of success stories that are unfolding more rapidly now out of the Indian startup ecosystem. We wholeheartedly believe that the Venture Capital business is - first and foremost - a people's business. We choose to invest in our people with equal focus, knowing that an exceptional team is critical to our success.

THE OPPORTUNITY:

- Before we make investment decisions, we work incredibly hard to leverage and activate our larger networks across the startup and funding ecosystem to make sure we are able to see the best founders building pioneering businesses for India and the world. We cultivate and maintain relationships with different **pipeline channels** so that we're able to reach founders working in stealth mode, second-time founders, and founders who are building things differently. We receive a lot of referrals through our network and work closely with micro VCs to help us reach folks who we can't access normally. We also actively maintain relationships with angel investors, incubators, accelerators, micro-VCs and college entrepreneurship cells to stay ahead of the game and find great founders.
- We also run programs for a smaller subset of our portfolio who are at a much earlier stage than our larger companies. The **Blume Founders Fund** is a carve-out program to build relationships with great founders and extend Blume's incredible platform strength and network to such founders while keeping the program distinct from the Core Investment Team's focus. We support these companies because we believe in their founders.
- We identify **co-investment opportunities** for our companies and manage a program for outreach and engagement with our larger network of investors.
- All of the above activities are covered within our **Network Programs** function on the Platform team. The Platform team at Blume is a pioneering effort to provide *full-stack* services to our portfolio companies, bring value add, share learnings and support their growth. Platform roles in VC are an integral part of building and supporting great companies, and have a long-term impact on relationships, goodwill, networks and building community.

THE ROLE:

We're hiring a **PROGRAM MANAGER** to support our **NETWORK PROGRAMS.** This role will work directly with Sarita Raichura, VP - Network Investment Programs to be a key gatekeeper of relationships, networks and pipeline channels and represent Blume within the external startup ecosystem for founders who are building. The role will also manage the Blume Founders Fund end to end - fund modelling to progress tracking to working closely with the founders to 'increase their probability of success..

This is a Platform role and a great opportunity for someone who is ***interested in working with a larger ecosystem of stakeholders and understanding the nuances of building strong relationships on behalf of a Venture Capital fund***. We envision this role to be a 2-year immersive experience where you'd get the opportunity to manage programs independently, model outcomes for our BFF program, closely track progress of each cohort, onboard and help manage new BFF portfolio companies. That apart, the role will required one to work closely with our micro-vc partners, super angels on one hand and our internal vertical stakeholders to track and ensure we close referral loops. Thirdly, independently conduct research and analytics to bring real, implementable solutions to the table for increasing our access to quality founder pipeline.

This is a non-Investments role, it sits within our Platform function.

What you'll do:

~40% time on Pipeline Sourcing and Management:

- You'll review and manage our **Central Pipeline and evaluate high quality referrals** from the leadership team, as well as work with analysts on sectoral pipeline.
- You will anchor and **deepen relationships with downstream investors** including micro VCs, incubators and accelerators across sectors and segments to source pipeline for Blume, and be present at external Demo Days and other platforms to seek out the best founders
- You'll conduct relevant **research and analytics** on our pipeline and referral funnels and provide insights to the team to improve our outreach and founder relationships.
- We have a small cohort of micro-VCs who we work closely with - you will the engage regularly and ensure all their loops are closed.

~40% time on Network Program and Portfolio Management:

- You'll manage the **Blume Founder's Fund** program on strategy, execution and reporting.
- You'll be the first point of contact for BFF founders and track relevant metrics, updates and data for their org performance. You'll work closely with the relevant Investment Leads as needed to support the BFF portfolio.
- You'll support the team in **presenting co-investment opportunities** and have the opportunity to present potential companies to the network.

~20% time will be spent on supporting your lead with **special projects** relevant to the organisation's strategic priorities.

What you'll get:

- A committed career path for 2 years with defined milestones, metrics and ambitious goals to challenge you and help you see the immediate value-add to our team.
- A flexible work environment with regular feedback and learning conversations and budgets for your growth and development.
- A hands-on as well as birds-eye view of Venture Capital, with immense opportunities for learning through apprenticeship, shadowing and informal mentoring
- The opportunity to see parts of Venture Capital behind the scenes and learn all aspects of strong network and community building, as well as build your own networks.

This role is perfect for you if:

YOU HAVE:

- 1-2 years of work experience in a flexible, fast-growing and young business environment.

- Strong data analysis skills with the ability to prepare and present complex data for easy consumption and review
- Excellent oral and written communication skills, with the ability to build rapport across different levels of stakeholders
- Ability to influence without authority and build meaningful relationships across the org chart
- High level of organisational skills and the ability to manage multiple projects simultaneously
- A willingness to actively seek out and incorporate feedback
- Exposure to the startup ecosystem through previous work, consulting projects or research
- Strong networks built through your academic/alumni experience or through startup community participation

YOU ARE:

- Excited at the opportunity to make impact at scale
- At heart, a catalyst - someone who wants to use all of their skills to help Blume's startups succeed and grow
- Comfortable with the idea of working in an Apprenticeship model - with lots of mentorship, feedback and guidance but significant individual responsibility and freedom
- An inherent hustler, focusing on 'closing the deal' and doing whatever it takes
- Obsessed with creating a tech-first approach to work, and comfortable working on different CRMs, platforms and low-code/no-code tools that we use in the course of our work as well as going incredibly deep into independent research to be able to bring the best value to our team
- Looking for the opportunity to work in a fast-growing company that is committed to providing support, growth and professional development as part of everyday work
- Not limited by a job description and designation, and open to the unique opportunity of working across functions at India's leading early-stage VC fund and charting your own learning journey
- Eager to work with some of the best minds in Indian VC and build a career, limited only by your own aspirations
- Highly comfortable with deadlines, and managing multiple projects simultaneously

This is a minimum 2-year commitment with the opportunity to continue supporting this function post that with additional responsibilities, or working with another function at Blume.. The role will be based out of our Bangalore office.